



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Learning Tree Academy
School Website: <http://thelearningtreeacademy.com>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

The Learning Tree Academy (Toccoa, GA, 30577) appears, based on public site content, to emphasize outdoor, holistic development and community-based learning rather than the classical liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; the great conversation; explicit liturgical or theological commitments; or Socratic pedagogy). Within the two rubric vectors used for this evaluation, the school shows minimal explicit alignment with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1): no evident Great Books program, no Trivium/Quadrivium framing, and no explicit theological or liturgical foundation in the public materials. The prevailing tone is a modern, experiential, outdoors-leaning program that markets holistic growth rather than formation through classical disciplines. This leads to a general assessment of NOT CLASSICAL across the six classical categories.

Key framework references informing this assessment include the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) lexicon and rubric, which enumerate explicit classical indicators (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; theology; Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; living curriculum; partnership with families) as well as inversions or negatives (e.g., secularism; project-based-only approaches; lack of Great Books; lack of formal formation). The lexicon and rubric establish concrete, text-driven signposts to assess public materials against classical aims. See the lexicon and the Six Essential Elements documentation for the indicators used in this evaluation.

Evidence from the school's crawl content emphasizes an outdoor, holistic approach rather than classical core traits (e.g., Great Books, Trivium, Paideia, liturgical practices, or explicit virtue formation) and does not contain clear references to theology, liturgy, or classical dialectic pedagogy in the public-facing materials. The homepage content explicitly promotes "Outdoor Learning School" and a holistic, community-focused message rather than classical canonical texts or traditional pedagogy.

- If you want a deeper, category-by-category substantiation with line-level evidence drawn from both the classical rubric and the school site, I provide that below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials emphasize holistic development and outdoor learning, but there is no explicit mention of transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgy, or communal sacred practices in the site text. The site highlights outdoor, holistic education rather than religious metaphysical framing.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: 1 (holistic development – aligns, indirectly, with holistic-formation language in the classical lexicon).
- Negative keywords present: 0 (no stated secular-flat or relativist signals are explicitly described in the site text, but the absence of positive theological framing is notable).
- Why this rating
- The rubric requires transcendental/moral realism, theology, or liturgical practices to be overtly present; these elements are not evidenced in the site's public materials. The presence of a holistic emphasis alone does not satisfy the core religious/metaphysical indicators of classical schooling as defined by the Six Essential Elements rubric. See the classical-element rubric (Positive Keywords) and the absence of the canonical religious/metaphysical markers.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site centers on holistic development and outside/experiential learning rather than formation of character toward virtue and wisdom in the classical sense. No explicit statements about virtue formation, truth/goodness/beauty as real telos, or the Paideia/Leisure-oriented aims are shown in the public content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0–1 (the site uses “holistic development” which maps loosely to formation via the classical lexicon’s “formation” and “holistic education” concepts, but not to the explicit classical telos or leisured formation language).
- Negative keywords present: 0 (no explicit modern workforce- or job-readiness framing is stated, but neither is there the classical telos language).
- Why this rating
- The official language of the site does not articulate the classical aims of formation of virtue, wisdom, or the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty as real ends. It foregrounds holistic development and outdoors in a way that does not map cleanly onto the classical purpose rubric. See the Six Essential Elements’ Section on Goal and Formation indicators.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site highlights “Outdoor Learning School,” K-5 programming, and farm-to-school elements, but there is no indication of Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin/Greek, or a Great Conversation approach in public content. The OLS K-5 and farm-to-school offerings imply a modern, experiential curriculum rather than the liberal-arts canon.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0–1 (no explicit Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; or Canonical texts indicated on the site).
- Negative keywords present: 0 (the site does not overtly reject classical elements, but it also does not present them).
- Why this rating
- The curriculum signals are not aligned with classical elements like Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin/Greek, or canonical Western history engagement. The site content points toward modern, experiential/outdoor programming rather than a classical canon. See the classical curriculum indicators for the Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium signals in the rubric.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public content emphasizes outdoor learning and holistic development rather than Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning, or memorizations/chanting. There is no explicit description of Socratic dialogue, memory work, or imitation-based classical pedagogy on the public pages.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0–1 (no explicit Socratic, Scholé, or chant/memorization pedagogy is evidenced; the site narrative is not pedagogically anchored in the classical methods).
- Negative keywords present: 0 (the site does not declare “experiential learning only” as its pedagogy, but it also does not present the classical, Socratic/restful pedagogies).
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit classical pedagogical methods (Socratic dialogue, Scholé, recitation, living books, etc.) in the public materials yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. See the Six Elements pedagogy indicators (Socratic, Scholé, recitation, memory work, etc.).

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site does not present a “living curriculum,” faculty portraits, or a formal faculty culture; there is no explicit description of teachers as models of virtue, mentors, or collegial teacher communities in the public pages. The site’s focus is programmatic (outdoor learning) rather than faculty culture or formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0–1 (no explicit mention of “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or “master-teacher model”).
- Negative keywords present: 0 (not explicitly stated, but absence implies not meeting classical faculty signals).
- Why this rating
- Without evidence of classical faculty features (master-teacher model; living curriculum; faculty as mentors; portraits of teacher; etc.), the category aligns with NOT CLASSICAL. See the category 5 indicators in the Six Elements lexicon.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The homepage and crawl content do not explicitly describe partnerships with parents as co-teachers, parent formation programs, frequent parent visits, or a culture of parent engagement. While there is a general emphasis on community, there is no explicit covenant of parent-education or co-teaching as described in classical rubrics.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0–1 (the public materials do not explicitly cite parent partnerships or family formation; if present in hidden sections, it is not visible in the crawl).
- Negative keywords present: 0
- Why this rating
- The classical rubric places strong emphasis on partnerships with families and parent formation as core elements; the public materials do not demonstrate these features. See the Parents & Community indicators in the Six Elements lexicon.

Aggregate assessment across categories: NOT CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Across all six categories, the public site content for Learning Tree Academy (Toccoa, GA, 30577) lacks explicit classical core elements (Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; rigorous Socratic pedagogy; theology; living curriculum; active parent partnership). The evidence from the school’s site centers on outdoor, holistic, and modern educational branding rather than classical canon, aligning with a NOT CLASSICAL classification per the Six Essential Elements rubric. The classical rubric’s Positive/Negative keyword indicators are drawn from the canonical lists and indicate the absence of the primary classical markers in the school’s public materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the school is assessed as NOT CLASSICAL in all six categories. No category is identified as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, so there is no targeted needle-moving guidance to move toward full classical status within the rubric.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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